Rodrigo Barrela
Nova School of Business and Economics
Job Market Candidate 26/27
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Fields

Labor Economics · Applied Econometrics · Panel Data Econometrics

EDUCATION

PhD in Economics Aug 2020 – Present
Nova School of Business and Economics
Lisbon, Portugal

MSc in Economics Sep 2017 – Jan 2019
Nova School of Business and Economics
Lisbon, Portugal

BSc in Economics Sep 2014 – Jul 2017
Nova School of Business and Economics
Lisbon, Portugal

REFERENCES

Pedro Portugal
Professor of Economics
Nova School of Business and Economics
josepedroportugal@gmail.com

Paulo Rodrigues
Professor of Economics
Nova School of Business and Economics
paulo.m.m.rodrigues@novasbe.pt

Paloma Lopez-Garcia
Director of the Institute for European Policymaking
Bocconi University
paloma.lopez-garcia@unibocconi.it

JOB MARKET PAPER

- 'The Value of Outside Options: Measurement, Impact and Inequality".
  Abstract: How do other employers shape a worker's pay? Using Portuguese matched employer–employee data, I identify labor markets from job mobility patterns and measure how the pay quality of alternative employers affects wages. Across markets, a 10% increase in outside options pay quality is associated with 3% higher wages. Within the same market and year, however, the same increase is associated with 1% lower current wages. This markdown is strongest among new hires and early-career workers, fades with tenure, and is followed by faster wage growth among workers who stay. Together, these patterns support a dynamic compensation story: valuable outside options shift compensation from current pay toward future progression. Despite shaping individual wages, this channel contributes little to aggregate wage inequality. Outside options nonetheless matter for inequality through a different channel, as market-level pay conditions account for about 15% of wage variance in Portugal.

WORKING PAPERS

- "Explaining Rural Start-Up Firms and Entrepreneurship in Portugal". With M. Marshalian, S. Sasso, and W. Vermeulen.
- "On the Asymmetrical Sensitivity of the Distribution of Real Wages to Business Cycle Fluctuations". With E. Costa and P. Portugal. Reject and Resubmit at American Economic Journal: Macro.
- "Medium-term Investment Responses to Activity Shocks: The Role of Corporate Debt". With P. Lopez-Garcia and R. Setzer.

WORK IN PROGRESS

- "An Estimator of Individual Peer Effects". With P. Guimarães and P. Portugal.

OTHER WORK

- "The Labor Market Decisions of Older Workers in Ageing Economies: Evidence from Spain and the UK". With P. Deb, G. Li, and C. Pizzinelli. IMF Working Paper 2025/030.

- "Exploring the Determinants of Early Retirement in Spain". With C. Pizzinelli. IMF Selected Issues Papers, Issue 78/2025.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant Sep 2018 – Present
Nova School of Business and Economics

Courses taught: Microeconometrics (MSc), Empirical Methods for Finance (MSc), Public Policy (MSc), Labour Economics (MSc), Global Economics (BSc), Linear Algebra with Python (BSc), and Data Analysis and Probability (BSc).

Consultant Jul 2025 – Dec 2025
European Commission – Joint Research Centre

Fund Internship Program Jun 2024 – Sep 2024
International Monetary Fund
European Department, Spain Team

Research Analyst Jul 2021 – Jul 2022
European Central Bank
Directorate General Economics – Supply Side, Labour Markets and Surveillance Division

Trainee Aug 2019 – Aug 2020
European Central Bank
Directorate General Economics – Supply Side, Labour Markets and Surveillance Division

Summer Intern Jul 2018 – Sep 2018
Banco de Portugal
Economics and Research Department

CONFERENCES

- Banco de Portugal Winter Research Workshop, 4th Edition (2025). Organised by Diana Bonfim, Miguel Faria e Castro, Nuno Paixão, André F. Silva, and Márcia Silva Pereira. Banco de Portugal, Lisbon.
- International Association for Applied Econometrics Conference, 13th Edition (2025). Organised by the International Association for Applied Econometrics. University of Torino, Turin.
- Portuguese Around the World: Central Banking Edition, 2nd Edition (2023). Organised by Diana Bonfim, Miguel Faria e Castro, Nuno Paixão, and André F. Silva. Banco de Portugal, Lisbon.
- Collective Bargaining in the 21st Century (2023). Organised by Ana Rute Cardoso and David Card. Academia das Ciências, Lisbon.

SUMMER SCHOOLS

- Expectations and Learning in Dynamic Structural Models (2025). The Econometric Society and University College London.
- New Developments in the Econometrics of Heterogeneous Workers and Firms (2023). Instructor: Prof. Elena Manresa (NYU). CEMFI.
- Topics in Labour Economics, Migration, and Intergenerational Mobility (2023). Instructor: Prof. Jan Stuhler (UC3M). ISEG Lisbon.
- Empirical Methods for Policy Evaluation (2023). Instructor: Prof. Mónica Costa Dias (University of Bristol). ISEG Lisbon.

HONOURS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

- Portuguese Science and Technology Foundation PhD scholarship (2022)
- Amélia de Mello Foundation Award (Best first-year PhD student) (2022)
- Haddad Foundation PhD scholarship (2020)
- Nova Fellowship for Excellence scholarship (2017)

SKILLS

Languages

Portuguese (Native), English (Fluent)